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Service location anomalies

Abstract

Disclosed techniques include using machine learning to detect an electrical anomaly in a power distribution system. In an example, a method includes accessing voltage measurements measured at an electric metering device and over a time period. The method further includes calculating, from voltage measurements and for each time window of a set of time windows, a corresponding average voltage and a corresponding minimum voltage. The method further includes applying a machine learning model to the average voltages and the minimum voltages. The machine learning model is trained to identify one or more predetermined electrical anomalies from voltages. The method further includes receiving, from the machine learning model, a classification indicating an identified anomaly. The method further includes based on the classification, sending an alert to a utility operator.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/216,375, filed Jun. 29, 2021, which is incorporated by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This application relates to using machine learning to detect abnormalities in power distribution systems.

BACKGROUND

(2) Electric power is distributed to consumers via power distribution systems. Power distribution systems are complex and availability of power is important to customers. Therefore, anomalies in power distributions systems can increase downtime, wear on parts, and escalate service costs if left unrepaired. But adding additional equipment to a power distribution system to detect anomalies can be expensive. Hence, detection of anomalies in power distribution systems by using existing components such as electric meters is desired.

SUMMARY

(3) Disclosed techniques include using machine learning to detect a electrical anomalies in a power distribution system. In an example, a method includes accessing voltage measurements measured at an electric metering device and over a time period. The method further includes calculating, from voltage measurements and for each time window of a set of time windows, a corresponding average voltage and a corresponding minimum voltage. The method further includes applying a machine learning model to the average voltages and the minimum voltages. The machine learning model is trained to identify one or more predetermined electrical anomalies from voltages. The method further includes receiving, from the machine learning model, a classification indicating an identified anomaly. The method further includes based on the classification, sending an alert to a utility operator.

(4) In another example, a system for detecting an anomaly in a resource distribution system includes a head end system and electric metering devices. The head end system includes a computing device and a machine learning model. Each electric metering device includes a sensor. Each electric metering device is electrically connected to a distribution transformer that that is upstream of the respective electric metering device. Each electric metering device is configured to obtain a respective set of voltage measurements from the respective sensor of the electric metering device. Each electric metering device is configured to provide the respective set of voltage measurements to the head end system. The head end system includes a machine learning model. The head end system is configured to obtain, from each of the electric metering devices, the respective set of voltage measurements. The head end system is further configured to access a first set of voltage measurements measured at a first electric metering device. The head end system is further configured to calculate, from the first set of voltage measurements and for each of a first set of time windows, a first corresponding average voltage and a first corresponding minimum voltage. The head end system is further configured to apply a machine learning model to the first average voltages and the first minimum voltages. The machine learning model is trained to identify, from voltage measurements, a first voltage signature that corresponds to the electrical anomaly. The head end system is further configured to receive, from the machine learning model, a first classification indicating a first loose connection. The head end system can be further configured to send a first alert to a utility operator based on the first classification. The first alert identifies the first electric metering device. The head end system is further configured to access a second set of voltage measurements measured at a second electric metering device. The head end system is further configured to calculate, from the second set of voltage measurements and for each of a second set of time windows, a second corresponding average voltage and a second corresponding minimum voltage. The second set of time windows can occur before the first plurality of time windows. The head end system is further configured to apply the machine learning model to the first average voltages, the first minimum voltages, the second average voltages, and the second minimum voltages. The head end system is further configured to receive, from the machine learning model, a second classification identifying a second voltage signature indicating a second loose connection. The head end system is further configured to send a second alert to a utility operator based on the second classification. The second alert identifies the second electric metering device.

(5) In another example, a method includes accessing a first set of voltage measurements measured at an electric metering device. The method further includes calculating, from the first set of voltage

measurements and for each of a first set of time windows, a first corresponding average voltage and a first corresponding minimum voltage. The method further includes applying a machine learning model to the first average voltages and the first minimum voltages. The machine learning model is trained to identify, from voltage measurements, a first voltage signature that corresponds to the electrical anomaly. The method further includes receiving, from the machine learning model, a first classification indicating a first loose connection. The method further includes sending a first alert to a utility operator based on the first classification. The method further includes calculating, from a second set of voltage measurements and for each of a second set of time windows, a second corresponding average voltage and a second corresponding minimum voltage. The second set of time windows can occur before the first plurality of time windows. The method further includes applying the machine learning model to the first average voltages, the first minimum voltages, the second average voltages, and the second minimum voltages. The method further includes receiving, from the machine learning model, a second classification identifying a second voltage signature indicating a second loose connection. The method further includes sending a second alert to a utility operator based on the second classification.

(6) These illustrative examples are mentioned not to limit or define the disclosure, but to provide examples to aid understanding thereof. Additional examples and further description are provided in the Detailed Description.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

(1) These and other features, aspects, and advantages of the present disclosure are better understood when the following Detailed Description is read with reference to the accompanying drawings, where:

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates an exemplary communication network topology of a power distribution system, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates an exemplary power distribution network, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3 depicts a flowchart of an exemplary process for using a machine learning model to detect anomalies, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 4 depicts calculating statistical voltage data obtained from a metering device, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure.

(6) FIG. 5 depicts a flowchart of an exemplary process for using a machine learning model to detect anomalies, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure.

(7) FIG. 6 depicts a flowchart of an exemplary process for training a machine learning model using supervised learning to detect anomalies, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure.

(8) FIG. 7 depicts a graph indicating voltage measurements associated with a loose connection, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure.

(9) FIG. 8 depicts a graph indicating voltage measurements associated with a seasonal overload, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure.

(10) FIG. 9 depicts a graph indicating voltage measurements associated with an excess voltage drop due to a long secondary line, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure.

(11) FIG. 10 illustrates an exemplary computing device, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(12) Aspects of the present invention relate to using machine learning to detect electrical anomalies in electrical systems by learning and identifying voltage patterns, or signatures, in voltage measurements obtained by metering devices, or meters, located at end user premises. Anomalies

can include, but are not limited to, a loose connection between a meter and a meter socket at an end user premises, a seasonal overload (for example, an overload that only occurs seasonally), and a long secondary line (for example, a connection from the distribution transformer to the end user premises). Each of these anomalies can result in an identifiable voltage signature at an end user premises.

(13) Accordingly, advantages of certain aspects include early identification of electrical anomalies, which can help with failure avoidance, improved system efficiency, and improved system reliability in the form of improved System Average Interruption Frequency Index (SAIFI) or System Average Interruption Duration Index (SAIDI) scores. For example, once an anomaly is identified, actions can be proactively taken to resolve the source of the anomaly and avoid an unplanned outage, resulting in these advantages.

(14) Additionally or alternatively, having identified an electrical anomaly, disclosed systems can retroactively analyze metering data from one or more meters and determine additional patterns that indicate the anomaly. While an untrained machine learning model that is unaware of a voltage signature identifying an anomaly may not be able to identify such a pattern, a machine learning model that is aware of the voltage signature can be trained to identify such voltage signatures. In this respect, disclosed solutions can provide earlier warnings of a developing electrical problem. For example, armed with the ability to identify a voltage signature that matches a loose connection, a trained machine learning model can identify patterns in the data from the corresponding electrical meter months or years before the loose connection becomes a serious problem.

(15) The following non-limiting example is provided for illustrative purposes. Voltage measurements are gathered at a metering device at a particular frequency (e.g. every fifteen minutes). Examples of suitable metering devices are smart meters or Advanced Metering Infrastructure (AMI) meters. The metering device transmits the voltage data over a communications network to a head end system, with or separately from metering data such as power consumption.

(16) Continuing the example, the head end system receives the voltage measurements from the metering device and derives statistical data from the voltage measurements. For instance, statistical data, such as a daily average and a daily minimum voltage, are calculated over a time period (e.g., one month). This statistical data is provided to a machine learning model. The machine learning model, previously trained to detect one or more anomalies from voltage data and/or derived statistics, determines a presence of an anomaly such as a loose connection or seasonal overload.

(17) Turning now to the figures, FIG. 1 illustrates an exemplary communication network topology of a power distribution system, in accordance with an embodiment. FIG. 1 includes head end system **100**; network connection **108**; collector **110**; network connections **112**, **114**, **116**, and **118**; metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128**; and end user premises **132**, **134**, **136**, and **138**. The communication network topology shown in FIG. 1 depicts an example of how various devices are interconnected in a communication network. The communication network topology is distinct from how power is distributed, as depicted in FIG. 2.

(18) In the example depicted in FIG. 1, one or more of metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128** measure one or more parameters such as voltage measurements, current measurements, phase measurements, real power consumption (watt-hours), real power (watts) and provide the parameters via network connections **112**, **114**, **116**, and **118** to collector **110**. In turn, collector **110** provides the metering data to head end system **100**. Head end system **100** then processes the data to detect anomalies using machine learning.

(19) Head end system **100** includes computing device **102** and machine learning model **104**. An example of a computing device is depicted with respect to FIG. 9. Computing device **102** can derive statistics from voltage data gathered by metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128** and/or provide the statistics to machine learning model **104**, which in turn can identify one or more electrical anomalies at metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128**. Examples of anomalies that can be

detected by machine learning model **104** include a loose connection (e.g., of a meter socket), a seasonal overload, and an excess voltage drop due to a long secondary distribution line. Exemplary voltage signatures that can signify these conditions are depicted in FIGS. **6**, **7**, and **8** respectively. (20) Metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128** are located at end user premises **132**, **134**, **136**, and **138** respectively. Metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128** can each include a computing device, memory, other storage capabilities, and one or more network connections. Metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128** can detect any parameters related to the distribution of electric power, for example, voltage, load, current, power consumption, or volt-ampere reactive (VAR) power. In some cases, individual metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128** can push the voltage measurements to the head end system **100**. In other cases, the head end system can pull the voltage measurements from the metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128**. In another aspect, the metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128** can be configured to push the voltage measurements to the head end system **100** at a specific frequency, which can be different from a frequency of transmission of metering data (e.g., power consumption data). For instance, metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128** can measure voltage at specific intervals such as every 15 minutes or every hour but can push power consumption data daily or monthly.

(21) The functionality discussed with respect to head end system **100** can be implemented on any combination of the head end system **100** (e.g., computing device **102**), one or more of metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128**, and a cloud-based system (i.e., a server connected via a persistent network connection). Examples of systems include AMI system and a meter data management (MDM) system.

(22) For example purposes, network connection **108** is depicted as a wired network connection whereas network connections **112**, **114**, **116**, and **118** are depicted as wireless network connections. Examples of typical networks include wireless (e.g., WiFi, Bluetooth, mesh, or cellular) and wired (e.g., Ethernet or power line communications) networks. But different configurations are possible. For instance, metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128** can communicate with each other and/or head end system **100** using any communication networks. Communications can also be sent from head end system **100** to metering device **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128**. In some configurations, collector **110** may not be present and metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128** communicate directly with the head end system **100**.

(23) FIG. **2** illustrates an exemplary power distribution network, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure. In the example depicted in FIG. **2**, power distribution system **200** includes a power source **202**; a power distribution substation transformer **204**; a feeder **208**; distribution transformers **210** and **212**; power distribution primary lines **240** and **241**, secondary lines **242**, **244**, **246**, and **248**; metering devices **222**, **224**, **226**, and **228**; and end user premises **232**, **234**, **236**, and **238**.

(24) One example of power source **202** is a reduced representation of a the bulk power system to which a power distribution substation transformer **204** is connected, which includes the power sub-transmission network, power transmission network, and power generation sources (e.g., power plant, a solar panel, or a wind turbine generator). Power distribution substation **204** transforms the voltage output from the power source **202** to a suitable level for a feeder **208**. The feeder **208** in turns feeds distribution lines **240** and **241**. Power distribution substation **210** transforms the voltage of distribution line **240** into a different voltage in secondary lines **242**, **244**, and **246**. Similarly, distribution transformer **212** transforms the voltage of distribution line **241** into a different voltage in secondary line **248**.

(25) As depicted, metering devices **222**, **224**, **226**, and **228** correspond to end user premises **232**, **234**, **236**, and **238** respectively. Metering devices **222**, **224**, **226**, and **228** can correspond to metering devices **122**, **124**, **126**, and **128** respectively. End user premises **232**, **234**, **236**, and **238** can correspond to end user premises **132**, **134**, **136**, and **138** respectively.

(26) Metering device **222** measures parameters on secondary line **242**, metering device **224**

measures parameters on secondary line **244**, metering device **226** measures parameters on secondary line **246**, and metering device **228** measures parameters on secondary line **248**. Because the length of each distribution line can be different, in some cases, an anomaly can occur due to a long secondary line. For instance, secondary line **248** may be longer than typical, resulting in an abnormally high voltage drop between distribution transformer **212** and end user premises **238**. This anomaly can be identified by machine learning model **104**.

(27) In some examples, a metering device may be associated with a power distribution secondary line distributing one or more phases of a multi-phase distribution system. For example, power distribution secondary lines **242** may include two phases of a three-phase power generation and distribution system. In this configuration, using voltage measurements obtained at metering device **222**, head end system **100** can determine that the different phases have different average and/or minimum voltages by providing measured voltages and/or statistics derived therefrom to machine learning model **104**.

(28) FIG. **3** depicts a flowchart of an exemplary process **300** for using a machine learning model to detect anomalies, accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure. For example purposes, process **300** is discussed as being performed by head end system **100**. But process **300** can be implemented on any computing device, for example, in a metering device.

(29) At block **302**, process **300** involves accessing a set of voltage measurements measured at a metering device and over a time period. For instance, head end system **100** accesses voltage measurements obtained from metering device **122**. Accessing the voltage measurements can include transmitting a request to the electric metering device and receiving the voltage measurements back from the electric metering device. In another example, an electric metering device can periodically transmit the voltage measurements to the head end system. For example purposes, process **300** is discussed with respect to FIG. **4**.

(30) FIG. **4** depicts calculating statistical voltage data obtained from a metering device, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure. FIG. **4** depicts data flow **400**, which depicts how average and minimum voltage data are derived for various time periods from data obtained by a single metering device. Data flow **400** includes voltage data **410**, which is obtained over a time period **420**, time windows **430a-n**, statistical data **440a-n**, and machine learning model **104**. Any length time period and any length time window can be used.

(31) Continuing the example, computing device **102** accesses voltage data **410**, which corresponds to time period **420**, and separates the voltage data **410** into multiple time windows **430a-n**. Time windows **430a-n** are smaller than time period **420**. Each of time window **430a-n** includes multiple voltages. For instance, if a particular time window is one day, and the frequency at which voltages were obtained is every fifteen minutes, then one time window would include ninety-six voltage measurements. In an example, time period **420** is a month and time windows **430a-n** are each one day. For example, time window **430a** is a first day, time window **430b** a second day, and so forth.

(32) Returning to FIG. **3**, at block **304**, process **300** involves calculating, from the set of voltage measurements and for each time window of a set of time windows, a corresponding average voltage and a corresponding minimum voltage. Continuing the example, computing device **102** computes statistical data **440a-n** from time windows **430a-n**. More specifically, computing device **102** computes statistical data **440a**, which includes an average and a minimum from time window **430a**, and statistical data **440b**, which includes an average and a minimum from time window **430b**, and so forth.

(33) While averages and minimums are discussed with respect to FIG. **4**, other statistical metrics such as median, mode, maximums, etc. derived from voltages or other parameters can be used by machine learning model **104**. In this case, machine learning model **104** is trained using these statistics.

(34) At block **306**, process **300** involves applying a machine learning model to the average voltages and the minimum voltages for the time period. Continuing the example, computing device **102**

provides statistical data **440a-n** to machine learning model **104**.

(35) Machine learning model **104** is trained to identify one or more electrical anomalies from voltages, as discussed further with respect to FIG. 6. In some cases, one or more of the average voltages and the minimum voltages are translated into one or more feature vectors. A feature vector is a vector containing multiple elements about an object (for example, an electrical meter). The feature vector can therefore include average voltages, minimum voltages, or other statistics. The feature vectors are in turn provided, one or more at a time, to machine learning model **104**.

(36) At block **308**, process **300** involves receiving, from the machine learning model, a classification indicating an identified electrical anomaly. Continuing the example, machine learning model **104** outputs a classification that identifies an electrical anomaly. Examples of anomalies include a loose connection to the power line at an end user premises, a seasonal overload in consumption, and a voltage drop caused by a long secondary line (connection from the distribution transformer to the end user premises).

(37) One example of an anomaly is a loose connection associated with the electric metering device, as discussed further with respect to FIG. 6. A loose connection can be represented by a first decrease in a minimum voltage over the time period and a second decrease in average voltage over the time period, in which the second decrease is less than the first decrease.

(38) Another example of an anomaly is a seasonal overload caused by power consumption measured by the electric metering device, as discussed further with respect to FIG. 7. Such an anomaly can be represented by one or more correlations between one or more peaks or valleys of the minimum voltages with one or more peaks or valleys of the average voltages.

(39) Machine learning model **104** can output classifications of one or more specific anomalies. In other cases, machine learning model **104** can output a determined probability of one or more classifications. For instance, machine learning model **104** may output a first probability that the voltages indicate a loose connection of 80% and a probability of 20% that a loose connection does not exist. In other cases, a set of probabilities may be generated such as a probability of 50% of a loose connection, 40% of a long secondary line, and 10% that neither anomaly exists. A machine learning model that generates a particular classification (e.g., positive or negative) may be a different type of model than a machine learning model that generates a range of probabilities.

(40) The output of machine learning model **104** is provided to computing device **102**. In some cases, computing device **102** can make a determination that when the probability is above a certain threshold, the corresponding classification is used. In some cases, computing device **102** can determine that when the probability is below the threshold, no classification is made.

(41) At block **310**, process **300** involves, based on the classification, sending an alert to a utility operator or adjusting one or more parameters of the power distribution system. For instance, computing device **102** can send an alert to a utility operator or send an alert to an engineer to visit a customer premises to perform a repair such as replacing a bad meter socket or meter. As a result, an electrical load on a line can be rebalanced, additional equipment can be added, or equipment (e.g. a transformer) can be replaced.

(42) In another example, at block **310**, computing device **102** can cause head end system **100** to adjust one or more parameters of the power distribution system. Examples of parameters that can be adjusted include line voltage, phase, load, reactance, capacitance, and so forth. In some cases, such adjustments can be performed remotely via a communications network, for example by communicating with a resource regulation device, which in turn makes the adjustments.

(43) In an aspect, data from multiple metering devices can be analyzed by machine learning model **104**. For instance, process **300** may be executed multiple times, once for each metering device. Alternatively, blocks **302-304** may be executed multiple times, once for each metering device, and then data from multiple metering devices is analyzed in aggregate form by machine learning model **104**, e.g., at block **308**. This analysis could occur in real-time or after a threshold amount of data has been buffered.

(44) In an example, head end system **100** accesses voltage measurements from two or more metering devices. Head end system **100** calculates statistical metrics for each of the metering devices and for each of the voltage measurements and for each time window. Head end system **100** then applies machine learning model **104** to the statistical metrics. In some cases, applying can result in an adjustment of the training of the machine learning model. Continuing the example, head end system **100** identifies one or more anomalies with one or more electrical metering devices.

(45) In some cases, the machine learning model can use topology information of the electric metering devices. For instance, given topography information (e.g., as depicted in FIG. 2), machine learning model **104** can determine whether an anomaly exists at one metering device but not on another metering device. From this determination, the machine learning model **104** can identify a problem on another component such as a distribution transformer. For example, if a particular anomaly is shown on metering device **222**, **224**, and **226**, but not on metering device **228**, then an anomaly may exist on distribution transformer **210** or distribution line **240**.

(46) As discussed further with respect to FIG. 9, another example of an anomaly is an excess voltage drop due to a long distribution line associated with the electric metering device. In some cases, determining this excess voltage drop involves collecting measurements from additional electric meters. For instance, the topology of such an electrical network may be that one or more distribution transformers are electrically connected to and upstream from a subset of electric metering devices via a distribution line. One identifiable anomaly can be identified by a difference between an average voltage of a subset of electrical metering devices and a daily average of a single electric metering device being above a threshold.

(47) FIG. 5 depicts a flowchart of an exemplary process **500** for using a machine learning model to detect anomalies, accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure. Relative to process **300** discussed with respect to FIG. 3, process **500** involves using a first identification of an anomaly (optionally including associated voltage data) in conjunction with machine learning to identify a second identification of an anomaly. The second identification of an anomaly can correspond to an anomaly that occurred earlier in time within the data than the first identification.

(48) For instance, process **500** can detect a loose connection in a first set of voltage data, then use the detected voltage signature in the same or a different machine learning model to identify a second voltage signature in statistical data (e.g., voltage data) originating from the same electrical meter or different electrical meters. For example, a loose connection may have been present for a while but not detected until the first classification. Given the first classification, earlier identification may be possible retroactively and/or on a different set of data.

(49) At block **502**, process **500** involves receiving, from the machine learning model and based on a first set of voltage measurements, a first classification indicating a first loose connection. At block **502**, process **500** involves similar operations as discussed with respect to blocks **302-308** of process **300**. The classification can include a voltage signature. Process **500** can optionally involve sending an alert to a utility operator based on the first classification, as discussed with respect to block **310** of process **300**.

(50) At block **504**, process **500** involves calculating, from a second set of voltage measurements and for each of a second set of time windows, a second corresponding average voltage and a second corresponding minimum voltage. At block **504**, process **500** involves similar operations as discussed with respect to block **304** of process **300**. The second set of voltages can be from the same electric meter from which the voltage data used at block **502** originated and/or can originate from different electric meter(s). The second set of voltages can originate occur before the first set of time windows (e.g., as discussed with respect to block **304** of process **300**).

(51) At block **506**, process **500** involves applying the machine learning model to the first voltage signature, the second average voltages, and the second minimum voltages. Continuing the example, computing device **102** provides one or more of the first voltage signature (e.g., identified at block

502), the first average and minimum voltages (e.g., identified at block **502**), the second average voltages, and the second minimum voltages to the machine learning model **104**. In some cases, a different machine learning model can be used than was used at block **502**. The machine learning models can be trained to identify one or more electrical anomalies from voltages, as discussed further with respect to FIG. **6**.

(52) At block **508**, process **500** involves receiving, from the machine learning model, a second classification identifying a second voltage signature indicating a second loose connection. Continuing the example, computing device **102** receives a second classification that identifies a second voltage signature. The second voltage signature can be identical, similar, or different from the first voltage signature.

(53) At block **510**, process **500** involves sending an alert to a utility operator based on the second classification. At block **510**, process **500** involves similar operations as discussed with respect to block **310** of process **300**.

(54) Machine learning model **104** is trained to detect one or more predetermined voltage signatures that each correspond to one or more anomalies. Different learning techniques can be used such as supervised learning (e.g., with labeled training data), unsupervised learning (e.g., no labels), or reinforcement learning. Training can be performed by head end system **100**, e.g., computing device **102**, or different computing system. In the case that training is performed by different computing system, then machine learning model **104** can be provided (e.g., downloaded) to head end system **100** and/or updated as necessary.

(55) In some cases, training can be performed at runtime. For instance, an operator can indicate that a classification or prediction of an anomaly is correct or incorrect and provide feedback to the computing device **102**, which in turn updates machine learning model **104** accordingly.

(56) During training, the machine learning model learns an algorithm to identify electrical anomalies. While FIG. **6** is discussed with respect to supervised learning, other learning techniques can be used. Additionally, the trained machine learning algorithm can be improved over time, for instance by additional training at runtime.

(57) FIG. **6** depicts a flowchart of an exemplary process **600** for training a machine learning model using supervised learning to detect anomalies, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure. In the supervised learning approach, a determined probability or classification is calculated and compared with an expected, or known, probability or classification. A loss function is calculated from the comparison. Based on the calculated loss function, machine learning model **104** adjusts internal parameters of the machine learning model to minimize the loss function. Examples of suitable machine learning models include neural networks, classifiers, and decision trees.

(58) At block **602**, process **600** involves accessing a set of training data pairs. Each training data pair comprises statistics (e.g., a set of average voltages and a set of minimum voltages for a time period) and an expected classification that indicates one or more electrical anomalies. Each of the training data pairs include data that is previously identified as part of a positive training set (i.e., corresponding to voltage data that corresponds to a previously identified voltage signature) and/or a negative training set (i.e., voltage data that does not correspond to the previously identified voltage signature). Process **600** is discussed as performed by computing device **102**. However, training can be performed by any computing system.

(59) At block **604**, process **600** involves providing one of the set of training data pairs to the machine learning model. Continuing the example, computing device **102** provides a training data pair of the training data pairs to machine learning model **104**.

(60) At block **606**, process **600** involves receiving, from the machine learning model, a determined classification. Continuing the example computing device **102** receives, from machine learning model **104**, a determined classification.

(61) At block **608**, process **600** involves calculating a loss function by comparing the determined

classification and the expected classification. Continuing the example, computing device **102** calculates a loss function by comparing the determined classification (i.e., received at block **606**) and the expected classification (i.e., included in the training data pair accessed at block **604**).

(62) At block **610**, process **600** involves adjusting internal parameters of the machine learning model to minimize the loss function. Continuing the example, computing device **102** adjusts the machine learning model **104** as appropriate.

(63) At block **612**, process **600** involves checking whether the training is complete. If the training is complete, then process **600** continues to block **614**, where the training ends. If the training is not complete, then process **600** returns to **604** and uses another training data pair to continue to train the machine learning model. Completion of the training can be indicated by an end to the training data, the loss function being minimized below a threshold level, or some other condition.

(64) In an aspect, machine learning model **104** is trained to detect multiple voltage signatures. In this case, machine learning model **104** can identify an electrical signature that is indicative of more than one electrical anomaly. For instance, machine learning model **104** could identify a loose socket connection and a seasonal overload. In this case, process **600** can be completed one or more times for each electrical anomaly.

(65) In a further aspect, machine learning model **104** is tested to ensure sufficient accuracy in classification of electrical anomalies. Typically, data used to test machine learning model **104** is not included in the data set used to train machine learning model (i.e., the training data pairs).

(66) In another aspect, machine learning model **104** can be trained in an unsupervised manner using historical data from metering devices. Historical data can include data from time period prior to the time period for which an initial identification of a defect was made. For instance, after a particular metering device is identified as presenting an anomaly (e.g. by analyzing voltages from the metering device as described in process **300**), computing device **102** and/or machine learning model **104** can analyze additional data from the metering device to determine whether any additional voltage signatures exist. For instance, a signature could be identified in historical data and subsequently, an earlier time at which a defect occurred can be identified. Using this approach, machine learning model **104** can identify one or more precursor patterns in gathered voltage data, potentially earlier than previously detectable using supervised techniques (e.g., process **600**).

(67) In a more detailed example, process **300** is used to identify five metering devices with loose connections. For instance, a month of historical voltage data is processed by process **300**. The five metering devices are fixed by a service person tightening screws on the bases of the metering devices. This process of identifying metering devices with loose connections can continue.

(68) Continuing the example, after several months, twenty meters are identified and remedied. But historical data for each meter over a period of a year for each of the metering devices is available. By training the machine learning model **104** with this historical data, machine learning model **104** identifies one or more additional precursor signatures that are common to all of the twenty meters. Such identified signatures can supplement and/or replace the signatures identified in process **500**. In this manner, training can continue over time, in an unsupervised or supervised fashion. Benefits of this continued training approach include identification of voltage signatures that can occur at unpredictable or unexpected times, thereby improving machine learning model **104**.

(69) FIG. 7 depicts a graph indicating voltage measurements associated with a loose connection, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure. Graph **700** depicts a daily average voltage **710** and a daily minimum voltage **720** measured by a metering device at an end user premises. Data corresponding to graph **700** is shown below in Table 1.

(70) As can be seen in graph **700**, large differences between the daily average voltage **710** and the daily minimum voltage **720** can exist at certain points. These differences indicate an arcing of a connection or frequent disconnections at the connection. Together, the measurements in graph **700** can form a voltage signature that indicates a loose socket connection. For instance, the size of the dips in minimum voltage **720** relative to the average voltage **710** can indicate a loose connection.

Machine learning model **104** is trained to identify these signatures as anomalies.

(71) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 data indicating a loose connection Daily average Daily minimum Date (Volts) (Volts) 1-Mar 121.2 120.3 2-Mar 120.7 119.7 3-Mar 121.4 120.6 4-Mar 122.7 121.9 5-Mar 119.3 110.7 6-Mar 122.7 121.9 7-Mar 121.4 120.6 8-Mar 122.7 121.9 9-Mar 119.9 111 10-Mar 118 109.7 11-Mar 121.4 120.6 12-Mar 122.7 121.9 13-Mar 122.7 121.9 14-Mar 119.3 110.7 15-Mar 121.4 120.6 16-Mar 121.2 120.4 17-Mar 120.7 119.9 18-Mar 122.7 121.9 19-Mar 122.7 121.9 20-Mar 121.4 120.6 21-Mar 122.7 121.9 22-Mar 120.7 119.9 23-Mar 121.4 120.6 24-Mar 122.7 121.9 25-Mar 119.3 110.7 26-Mar 121.4 120.6 27-Mar 121.2 120.4 28-Mar 120.7 119.9 29-Mar 122.7 121.9 30-Mar 117.2 108 31-Mar 121 112

(72) FIG. **8** depicts a graph indicating voltage measurements associated with a seasonal overload, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure. Graph **800** depicts a daily average voltage **810** and a daily minimum voltage **820** measured by a metering device at an end user premises. Data for Graph **800** is shown below in Table 2. Here, the time period used is a year and the time period is a month.

(73) The data shows voltage measurements from January to December. As can be seen, during April to September, there is a higher load as indicated by a lower voltage. These dips in voltage can form signatures that indicate a transformer being overloaded. For instance, the relative alignment of the peaks and valleys in the minimum voltage **820** relative to peaks and valleys of the average voltage **810** can indicate seasonal overload. Machine learning model **104** is trained to identify these signatures as anomalies.

(74) TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 2 data indicating a seasonal overload Daily average Daily minimum Date (Volts) (Volts) 1-Jan 123 121.9 1-Feb 122.9 121.8 1-Mar 123.1 122 1-Apr 122 120.9 1-May 120 118.9 1-Jun 118.9 117.8 1-Jul 118.5 117.4 1-Aug 118.6 117.5 1-Sep 118.7 117.6 1-Oct 122.6 121.5 1-Nov 121.9 120.8 1-Dec 123.1 122

(75) FIG. **9** depicts a graph indicating voltage measurements associated with an excess voltage drop due to a long secondary line, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure. Graph **900** depicts a daily average voltage **910** of all the meters behind a service transformer (e.g., metering devices **222**, **224**, and **226**) in comparison with a daily average voltage **920** measured by a metering device at an end user premises (metering device **226**). Graph **900** is shown for one month of measurements, as shown below in Table 3.

(76) As can be seen in graph **900**, there exists a large separation between daily average voltage in all the meters behind a service transformer in comparison to the daily average voltage of the meter with the long secondary line. To recognize this signature some topology information is required. This topology information associates metering devices with transformers for the purpose of using voltages to recognize this particular pattern. Machine learning model **104** can recognize this signature by comparing the average voltage of all the metering devices that are behind the transformer with the daily average of each metering device.

(77) TABLE-US-00003 TABLE 3 data indicating an excess voltage drop Daily average of meters Daily average of one meter behind a transformer behind the transformer Date (Volts) (Volts) 1-Mar 121.2 116.2 2-Mar 120.7 114.7 3-Mar 121.4 114.9 4-Mar 122.7 117.7 5-Mar 121 116 6-Mar 122.7 116.7 7-Mar 121.4 114.9 8-Mar 122.7 117.7 9-Mar 121.2 116.2 10-Mar 122 116 11-Mar 121.4 116.4 12-Mar 122.7 116.7 13-Mar 122.7 116.2 14-Mar 120.6 115.6 15-Mar 121.4 116.4 16-Mar 121.2 116.2 17-Mar 120.7 115.7 18-Mar 122.7 116.7 19-Mar 122.7 116.2 20-Mar 121.4 116.4 21-Mar 122.7 117.7 22-Mar 120.7 114.7 23-Mar 121.4 114.9 24-Mar 122.7 117.7 25-Mar 121.6 116.6 26-Mar 121.4 115.4 27-Mar 121.2 114.7 28-Mar 120.7 115.7 29-Mar 122.7 116.7 30-Mar 119.7 113.2 31-Mar 121 116

(78) FIG. **10** illustrates an exemplary computing device, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure. Any suitable computing system may be used for performing the operations described herein. The depicted example of a computing device **1000** includes a processor **1002** communicatively coupled to one or more memory devices **1004**. The processor **1002** executes

computer-executable program code **1030** stored in a memory device **1004**, accesses data **1020** stored in the memory device **1004**, or both. Examples of the processor **1002** include a microprocessor, an application-specific integrated circuit (“ASIC”), a field-programmable gate array (“FPGA”), or any other suitable processing device. The processor **1002** can include any number of processing devices or cores, including a single processing device. The functionality of the computing device may be implemented in hardware, software, firmware, or a combination thereof.

(79) In some aspects, computing device **1000** can include at least one sensor configured to measure parameters relating to the resource of a resource distribution network. For example, in an electricity distribution system, the sensor can measure power consumption, voltage, current, etc. In some aspects, the computing device **1000** may include multiple sensors. For example, a computing device **1000** may include both a power and a temperature sensor.

(80) The memory device **1004** includes any suitable non-transitory computer-readable medium for storing data, program code, or both. A computer-readable medium can include any electronic, optical, magnetic, or other storage device capable of providing a processor with computer-readable instructions or other program code. Non-limiting examples of a computer-readable medium include a flash memory, a ROM, a RAM, an ASIC, or any other medium from which a processing device can read instructions. The instructions may include processor-specific instructions generated by a compiler or an interpreter from code written in any suitable computer-programming language, including, for example, C, C++, C#, Visual Basic, Java, or scripting language.

(81) The computing device **1000** may also include a number of external or internal devices, such as input or output devices. For example, the computing device **1000** is shown with one or more input/output (“I/O”) interfaces **1008**. An I/O interface **1008** can receive input from input devices or provide output to output devices. One or more busses **1006** are also included in the computing device **1000**. The bus **1006** communicatively couples one or more components of a respective one of the computing device **1000**.

(82) The computing device **1000** executes program code **1030** that configures the processor **1002** to perform one or more of the operations described herein.

(83) The computing device **1000** also includes a network interface device **1010**. The network interface device **1010** includes any device or group of devices suitable for establishing a wired or wireless data connection to one or more data networks. The network interface device **1010** may be a wireless device and have an antenna **1014**. The computing device **1000** can communicate with one or more other computing devices implementing the computing device or other functionality via a data network using the network interface device **1010**.

(84) The computing device **1000** can also include a display device **1012**. Display device **1012** can be a LCD, LED, touch-screen or other device operable to display information about the computing device **1000**. For example, information could include an operational status of the computing device, network status, etc.

(85) While the present subject matter has been described in detail with respect to specific aspects thereof, it will be appreciated that those skilled in the art, upon attaining an understanding of the foregoing, may readily produce alterations to, variations of, and equivalents to such aspects. Accordingly, it should be understood that the present disclosure has been presented for purposes of example rather than limitation and does not preclude inclusion of such modifications, variations, and/or additions to the present subject matter as would be readily apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art.

Claims

1. A method of using machine learning to detect an electrical anomaly in a power distribution system, the method comprising: accessing a first plurality of voltage measurements measured at an

electric metering device; calculating, from the first plurality of voltage measurements and for each of a first plurality of time windows, a first corresponding average voltage and a first corresponding minimum voltage; training a machine learning model by: accessing a set of training data pairs, wherein each training data pair comprises one or more of (i) a training set of average voltages and a set of minimum voltages, (ii) a training set of average voltages of all the electric metering devices connected to a distribution transformer, or (iii) a training set of average voltages of one electric metering device that is behind the distribution transformer and an expected classification that indicates one or more electrical anomalies; providing one training data pair of the set of training data pairs to the machine learning model; receiving, from the machine learning model, a determined classification; calculating a loss function by comparing the determined classification and the expected classification; and adjusting internal parameters of the machine learning model to minimize the loss function; applying the machine learning model to the first average voltages and the first minimum voltages, wherein the machine learning model is trained to identify, from voltage measurements, a first voltage signature that corresponds to the electrical anomaly; receiving, from the machine learning model, a first classification indicating a first loose connection; based on the first classification, sending a first alert to a utility operator; calculating, from a second plurality of voltage measurements and for each of a second plurality of time windows, a second corresponding average voltage and a second corresponding minimum voltage, wherein the second plurality of time windows occur before the first plurality of time windows; applying the machine learning model to the first average voltages, the first minimum voltages, first voltage signature, the second average voltages, and the second minimum voltages; receiving, from the machine learning model, a second classification identifying a second voltage signature indicating a second loose connection; and based on the second classification, sending a second alert to the utility operator.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the second plurality of voltage measurements are measured at an additional electric metering device.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein the first voltage signature includes a first decrease in a minimum voltage over a time period and a second decrease in average voltage over the time period, and wherein the second decrease is less than the first decrease.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein the second plurality of voltage measurements are measured at the electric metering device.

5. The method of claim 1, further comprising applying the machine learning model to topology information that associates the electric metering device with one or more distribution transformers that are electrically connected to the electric metering device via a distribution line.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein accessing the first plurality of voltage measurements comprises transmitting a request to the electric metering device and receiving the first plurality of voltage measurements from the electric metering device.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein the set of training data pairs further comprise topology information that associates one or metering devices with one or more distribution transformers.

8. A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium storing computer-executable program instructions, wherein when executed by a processing device, the computer-executable program instructions cause the processing device to perform operations comprising: accessing a first plurality of voltage measurements measured at an electric metering device; calculating, from the first plurality of voltage measurements and for each of a first plurality of time windows, a first corresponding average voltage and a first corresponding minimum voltage; training a machine learning model by: accessing a set of training data pairs, wherein each training data pair comprises one or more of (i) a training set of average voltages and a set of minimum voltages (ii) a training set of average voltages of all the electric metering devices connected to a distribution transformer, or (iii) a training set of average voltages of one electric metering device that is behind the distribution transformer and an expected classification that indicates one or more electrical anomalies; providing one training data pair of the set of training data pairs to the machine learning

model; receiving, from the machine learning model, a determined classification; calculating a loss function by comparing the determined classification and the expected classification; and adjusting internal parameters of the machine learning model to minimize the loss function; applying the machine learning model to the first average voltages and the first minimum voltages, wherein the machine learning model is trained to identify, from voltage measurements, a first voltage signature that corresponds to an electrical anomaly; receiving, from the machine learning model, a first classification indicating a first anomaly; based on the first classification, sending a first alert to a utility operator; calculating, from a second plurality of voltage measurements and for each of a second plurality of time windows, a second corresponding average voltage and a second corresponding minimum voltage, wherein the second plurality of time windows occur before the first plurality of time windows; applying the machine learning model to the first average voltages, the first minimum voltages, the second average voltages, and the second minimum voltages; receiving, from the machine learning model, a second classification identifying a second voltage signature indicating a second anomaly; and based on the second classification, sending a second alert to the utility operator.

9. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein one or more of the first anomaly and the second anomaly relate to a loose connection associated with the electric metering device.

10. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein one or more of the first anomaly and the second anomaly is represented by a first decrease in a minimum voltage over a time period and a second decrease in average voltage over the time period, and wherein the second decrease is less than the first decrease.

11. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein one or more of the first anomaly and the second anomaly is represented by one or more correlations between one or more peaks or valleys of the first minimum voltages with one or more peaks or valleys of the first average voltages.

12. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein when executed by a processing device, the computer-executable program instructions cause the processing device to apply the machine learning model to topology information that associates the electric metering device with one or more distribution transformers that are electrically connected to the electric metering device via a distribution line.

13. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein accessing the first plurality of voltage measurements comprises transmitting a request to the electric metering device and receiving the plurality of voltage measurements from the electric metering device.

14. A system for detecting an electrical anomaly in a resource distribution system, the system comprising: a head end system comprising a computing device and a machine learning model; and a plurality of electric metering devices, each electric metering device comprising a sensor, each electric metering device electrically connected to a distribution transformer that is upstream of the respective electric metering device, and each electric metering device configured to: obtain, from the respective sensor of the electric metering device, a respective plurality of voltage measurements; and provide the respective plurality of voltage measurements to the head end system, wherein the head end system is configured to: access a first plurality of voltage measurements measured at a first electric metering device of the plurality of electric metering devices; calculate, from the first plurality of voltage measurements and for each of a first plurality of time windows, a first corresponding average voltage and a first corresponding minimum voltage; train the machine learning model trained by: accessing a set of training data pairs, wherein each training data pair comprises one or more of (i) a training set of average voltages and a set of minimum voltages, (ii) a training set of average voltages of all the electric metering devices connected to a distribution transformer, or (iii) a training set of average voltages of one electric metering device that is behind the distribution transformer and an expected classification that

indicates one or more electrical anomalies; providing one training data pair of the set of training data pairs to the machine learning model; receiving, from the machine learning model, a determined classification; calculating a loss function by comparing the determined classification and the expected classification; and adjusting internal parameters of the machine learning model to minimize the loss function; apply the machine learning model to the first average voltages and the first minimum voltages, wherein the machine learning model is trained to identify, from voltage measurements, a first voltage signature that corresponds to the electrical anomaly; receive, from the machine learning model, a first classification indicating a first loose connection; based on the first classification, send a first alert to a utility operator, wherein the first alert identifies the first electric metering device; access a second plurality of voltage measurements measured at a second electric metering device of the plurality of electric metering devices; calculate, from the second plurality of voltage measurements and for each of a second plurality of time windows, a second corresponding average voltage and a second corresponding minimum voltage, wherein the second plurality of time windows occur before the first plurality of time windows; apply the machine learning model to the first average voltages, the first minimum voltages, the second average voltages, and the second minimum voltages; receive, from the machine learning model, a second classification identifying a second voltage signature indicating a second loose connection; and based on the second classification, send a second alert to the utility operator, wherein the alert identifies the second electric metering device.

15. The system of claim 14, wherein the head end system is further configured to further train the machine learning model the plurality of voltage measurements from at least one electric metering device.

16. The system of claim 14, wherein the head end system is further configured to: apply, to the machine learning model, topology information that associates the plurality of electric metering devices with one or more distribution transformers that are electrically connected to and upstream of the plurality of electric metering devices via a distribution line, and wherein the electrical anomaly is a difference between an average voltage of the plurality of electric metering devices and a daily average of the one of the plurality of electric metering devices being above a threshold.

17. The system of claim 14, wherein the first voltage signature includes a first decrease in a minimum voltage over a time period and a second decrease in average voltage over the time period, and wherein the second decrease is less than the first decrease.

18. The system of claim 14, wherein accessing the plurality of voltage measurements comprises transmitting a request to the respective electric metering device and receiving the plurality of voltage measurements from the respective electric metering device.
